

KORI MEAD

Backend / Platform Engineer — Python & Data Infrastructure

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Backend-focused Python Engineer with 4+ years of professional experience designing and operating resilient APIs, data ingestion pipelines, and platform infrastructure. Proven track record supporting enterprise-scale systems, high-concurrency backends (25,000+ users), and analytics-heavy workloads. Specialized in async systems, reliability engineering, observability, and automation.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python (Expert), SQL (Advanced/Complex Analytics), JavaScript (ES6)

Backend & APIs: FastAPI, Pydantic, SQLAlchemy, AsyncIO, WebSockets, Background Workers

Data & Analytics: PostgreSQL, Snowflake, Airtable, Hex, KPI Dashboards

Automation & Ingestion: Selenium, undetected-chromedriver, large-scale scraping, normalization pipelines

Infrastructure: AWS (S3, Boto3), Docker, Git, CI/CD, Pytest

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Python Systems Engineer

Mercor (Remote) | April 2025 – September 2025

- Stabilized critical AI ingestion pipelines for a \$100M enterprise client by redesigning automation, recovery workflows, and failure isolation.
- Designed centralized FastAPI services to manage high-volume traffic while maintaining consistent sub-200ms latency.
- Built SQL-driven operational dashboards (Snowflake, Hex) to track throughput, latency, and system health across production datasets.
- Identified bottlenecks and regressions using complex analytical SQL and implemented self-healing pipelines with circuit breakers.

Independent Systems Developer

Self-Employed (Consulting) | January 2021 – March 2025

- Architected high-availability Python backends supporting ~25,000 concurrent users and analytics-heavy workflows.
- Delivered automation and data ingestion systems focused on reliability, visibility, and scale.
- Developed a commercial AI-assisted data labeling platform (Snowball) featuring adaptive retraining and YOLOv8 model support.
- Engineered resilient large-scale web scraping systems using Selenium and undetected-chromedriver to bypass bot detection.
- Managed the full lifecycle of proprietary data tools, including Stripe-integrated licensing and feature gating.

SELECTED SYSTEMS & BACKEND PROJECTS

EdgeAI — Tennis Statistics & Analytics Platform

Real-time sports data infrastructure and analytics system

- Engineered resilient scraping pipelines to monitor live match data under frequent upstream changes.
- Built backend systems supporting live data ingestion and persistence for thousands of active users.
- Designed fault-tolerant architecture to handle unpredictable data source availability and format changes.

Snowball Annotator — AI Data Infrastructure Platform

Commercial machine learning data labeling and model training platform

- Designed an AI-assisted data labeling platform featuring an adaptive retraining pipeline using YOLOv8.
- Implemented automated YOLO-format exports, dataset versioning, and state persistence.
- Built comprehensive tooling for annotation workflows, model evaluation, and iterative improvement cycles.
- Integrated Stripe for licensing management and feature gating across subscription tiers.

EDUCATION & TECHNICAL FOUNDATION

United States Air Force

Technical & Electrical Systems Training

- Foundation in troubleshooting, diagnostics, and mission-critical operations under pressure.
- Developed systematic approach to problem-solving and reliability-focused mindset.

Continuous Self-Directed Learning

Software Engineering & Backend Systems | 2014 – Present

- Deep expertise in Python ecosystem, async programming patterns, and distributed systems.
- Ongoing study of system design, reliability engineering, and modern backend architectures.